

DIOCESE OF DOWN AND CONNOR Parish of Dunloy and Cloughmills

Are seeking to recruit a part-time Caretaker. The role will be based at Bridge Road Dunloy. Availability to work flexible hours is required including evenings and weekends. Rate of Pay £12.71

Full details on www.downandconnor.org or Community NI website as well as Church posters. **Closing date 12 noon Monday 28th September**

Down and Connor Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer

ST OLCAN'S PRIMARY SCHOOL, ARMOY Temporary Building Supervisor

Required - require a temporary cleaner for 18.5 hours per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended, experience preferred. Please send your CV to mkennedy502@c2kni.net if you would be interested in this post.

TRÓCAIRE Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. Our first Sunday Mass is 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

VINTED & MORE NIGHT Come along & grab a bargain!! Friday 23rd Oct 2026 From 5pm-8pm Cloughmills Community Hall A night filled with selling & buying preloved clothing & local vendors selling their goods!! Free admission / Everyone welcome!! See Vinted & More on Facebook!!

SVP.Helpline 07349983363

Bulletin notices by 12 noon Thursdays



Twenty Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time
13 September 2026

Very Rev. Canon Colm McBride PP :

Parochial House 44 Lough Road Loughguile BT44 9JN

Tel: 028 276 41206

Email: loughguile@downandconnor.org

Facebook: St Patrick's and St MacNissi's

Parish Office Hours Mon Wed Thurs 10 a.m.- 2.30 p.m.

Tues 10-4.30. p.m.

PARISH MASS NOTICE -THIS INCOMING WEEK THERE WILL BE NO PARISH MASS ON MONDAY , TUESDAY OR WEDNESDAY

We are called to forgive; and that can be really difficult.

You have been defrauded by the banks of your life's savings - can you forgive?

You were abused as a child - can you forgive?

You were done out of a job because another lied to get it - can you forgive?

The answer is maybe 'no'.

What then does God want?

He asks us to open our hearts to the other so that we may forgive. Forgiveness is the deepest of God's desires on our behalf, and he hopes that we can forgive each other.

Our hurts and burdens are heavy to carry through life. To forgive can release some of that weight. The person who hurt us may be dead, or may not even know (or care) that we are hurting. When we desire to forgive but don't know how, one way of looking for this strength is to pray for it. We often pray, 'Lord, make my heart like yours'. When we pray that we are praying to be forgiving people!

Another way is to pray for the person. When we realise that as God loves me, he also loves everyone, we may find a spark or light of forgiveness in our souls. Out of this we may find the will to meet the other and talk to him or her, and find the grace of forgiveness between us. Forgiveness sometimes comes slowly. When God sees us wanting to be on the road to forgiveness, he gives us the graces we need to unburden ourselves and be able to love like him.

Sit in silence for a while, and send a blessing or prayer to someone you need to forgive.

Lord, I ask - make my heart like yours. (CatholicIreland.net)

PARKING AT ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

Last week a young child on a bicycle was almost knocked down as she attempted to cross the Coolkeeran Road outside the Church.

She had correctly chosen the spot where the Kerb is lowered to accommodate pedestrians moving to and from the Church Car park.

However, vehicles had been parked on the road outside the Church gate and she wasn't immediately seen by the driver of the oncoming vehicle.

Fortunately she wasn't physically hurt.

As parishioners will be aware, the Coolkeeran Road is an arterial road within the parish, the Coolkeeran / Lough Road junction is one of the busiest within our parish.

It is imperative that parishioners take action now ,change practice and park at all times in the Church car park and not on the road outside the Church gate.

HLI IRELAND: Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

THE LEGION OF MARY ANNUAL PILGRIMAGE to Knock Shrine will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: 07471 537 051

ALZHEIMER'S SOCIETY MEMORY WALK is back for 2026! Take part in Memory Walk this autumn and walk to fund faster diagnosis and vital support.. Belfast Ormeau Pk on Sat **26 Sept** Sign up todaymemorywalk.org.uk 0300 330 5452

Saturday 12 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	Ministers of the Word Shane McMahon	Ministers of the Eucharist A. McNaughton & M. McMullan <i>Anniversary Mass Rosemarie Laverty</i>
Sunday 13 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	Pat McAuley	Joseph McCarry & M. Young <i>Anniversary Mass Ann McFadden</i>
	11.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Orlagh McArthur	C. Casey & G. McMillan
Monday 14 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St MacNissi's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Tuesday 15 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Wed 16 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Thursday	9.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Mass followed by Adoration 10.00 a.m. -12 noon.	
Friday	9.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Mass	
Saturday 19 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	Ministers of the Word Damian McCloskey	Ministers of the Eucharist M. McCloskey & T. Devlin <i>Anniversary Mass John Reid</i>
Sunday 20 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	Majella Murray	V.McDonnell & M.McKinley
	11.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Paula Casey	T.McIntyre & B. Connolly

ANNIVERSARIES Bridie Carey Annie Douthart Anna Greene
Patrick and Ellen Hetherington Rosemarie Laverty Harry McAuley
Eilish McClements John McCloskey Ann McFadden Tilly McGill
Tom O'Neill Annemarie Rafferty John Reid Joe Robinson John Waide

BAPTISMS The Sacrament of Baptism will be celebrated on the **1st and 3rd Sunday** of the month **only** after the 11.30 a.m. Mass. To book please contact the Parish Office. A copy of the child's long birth certificate is required within a week of booking. On the day please bring a Baptism Candle and a white Shawl.

ANNIVERSARY/MONTH MIND MASS Please now book through the office, these can be booked for any scheduled Mass **excluding Sunday 11.30 a.m.**

WEDDING BOOKING Please ring the office for initial bookings.

WEEKLY COLLECTION £1415.00 Thank you for your support.
Autumn Offering will be taken up **next** weekend.

DAY TRIP TO KNOCK: Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on 02827641120 or 07871626940. Price approx. £30 depending on numbers.



PARISH BULLETIN

Sunday 13 September 2026
Twenty Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Francis O'Brien

CONTACTS

Parish Office: 028 90 324597

Address: 199 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL

Emergency Telephone: 07496818511.

Office hours 10.30am – 2.00pm Tuesday -Thursday, closes 1pm on Friday.

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since St Patrick's is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: stpatricks@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricks.org

 [St. Patrick's Parish, Belfast | Belfast | Facebook](#)

 [@stpatricks200](#)

St Patrick's Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes comprising the Parishes of Holy Family, St Gerards and St Patrick's.

Holy Family – Fr Michael Spence, Fr John O' Lavery (028 90 743119)

St Gerards – Fr Patrick O'Keeffe (028 90 774833)

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Fr Gerry Clarke SJ
gclarke@jesuit.ie

St Patrick's Primary School: 028 90 351478

Blessed Trinity College: 028 90 370665

WEEKEND MASS

Saturday Vigil 6pm. Sunday Morning 9am & 11am.
Sunday Evening 6pm Candlelit Mass.

WEEKDAY MASS Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 10am.

CONFESSIONS Saturdays 5.30pm to 5.50pm.

REST IN PEACE

Barry Geoghan.

Inurnment: Eamon Kirk.



MASS INTENTIONS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Saturday 6pm: Eamon Kirk Months Mind.

Sunday 9am: Elizabeth Harley 2nd Anniversary.

Sunday 6pm: Annie Waterworth Birthday Remembrance, Christy Matthews Anniversary.

Thursday 10am: Mary Meighan 29th Anniversary, Bridie Gallagher 2nd Anniversary.

FEAST/MEMORIAL DAYS THIS WEEK

Monday 14 September - The Exaltation of the Holy Cross. The discovery of the True Cross is dated to 320. In 335 the churches on Calvary were dedicated and the cross that St Helena discovered was venerated there. The annual commemoration of that event has been celebrated since, in praise of the redemption won for us by Christ.

Tuesday 15 September - Our Lady of Sorrows. Mary, standing by the Cross, suffered intensely with her Son and united herself as his Mother to his sacrifice, consenting with love to the offering of the victim who was born of her, whom she also offered to the eternal Father.

Thursday 17 September - St Hildegard, 1098-1179, founder of the monastery of Bingen around 1150, she knew the natural sciences, was a musician and composer, a writer and a mystic. She worked for the reform of religious life and the Church. She was canonised and declared a doctor of the Church in 2012.



St Vincent de Paul 028 90351561

NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50th BIRTHDAY CELEBRATIONS

Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr John O'Lavery would like to thank all those who organised and supported the Rosary and Mass at the Grotto as part of the 50th

Birthday Celebrations. The presence and support of Bishop Alan was also very much appreciated. **"We are deeply grateful to everyone for your dedication, devotion, and steadfast faith in Holy Mary. Your prayers and commitment are a beautiful expression of love for Our Blessed Mother. May Mary continue to guide our community and bring us closer to her Son, Jesus."**

ROSARY at the Lourdes Grotto in the New Lodge will continue every Monday at 7pm and Thursday at 7.30pm. All welcome.



TWENTY FOURTH SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

Forgiveness

In the Gospel, Jesus makes it clear that if we want God to forgive us, we must forgive others. We all know how hard it can be to forgive. At the same time, we know how lovely it is to be forgiven. Today's Gospel raises the question of sin between brothers and sisters, that is, fellow-Christians. The Psalm talks about the greatness of God's forgiveness, (which contrasts with our miserly forgiveness). Anyone who is forgiven has an obligation to forgive. If we cannot bring ourselves to do this, it is an indication that we haven't experienced God's forgiveness. The position of the servant in Jesus' story was absolutely hopeless. He owed the king so much money that even if he worked forever, he would not be able to repay him. This is our situation before God. We can't win God's forgiveness. All we can do is plead for his mercy.

READINGS: First Reading (Ecclesus 27:30-28:7). In refusing to forgive those who have sinned against us, we exclude ourselves from receiving God's forgiveness for our own sins. Second Reading (Rom 14:7-9). The entire existence of a Christian is for Christ and for others. Gospel (Mt 18-21-35). We must be willing to extend to others the generous forgiveness God has extended to us.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

Down and Conon Diocese is renewing and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. We are looking for members of the Parish who would be willing to attend an Information Meeting at one of these venues:

Thursday 1 Oct: The Parish Centre, Ballymena 8pm

Friday 2 Oct: St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick 8pm

See Poster in the Church for more details. Contact the Parish Office if you would like to attend.

JESUIT CENTRE EVENTS

Poetry & Presence begins on Thursday 1 October at 7pm in the Belfast Jesuit Centre, opening with the theme of **Water in this Season of Creation**. You're invited into a quiet, reflective evening of poetry, art, music, and Scripture: a space to pause, breathe, and let the imagery of water in God's story speak to the depths of your own heart.

Thursday 1 October 7.00pm Belfast Jesuit Centre. To register, visit

<https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/poetry-presence/>

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN RETREAT

As Fr Francis will be attending the retreat there will be no weekday Mass this **Tuesday 15 and Wednesday 16 September**.

HOLY FAMILY PARISH

Present an **Evening of Music in Holy Family Church** in aid of **Newington Day Centre**. Featuring Neil Martin, Cavehill Community Choir and Friends, **Sunday 4 October 7pm**. Tickets £10 available from Holy Family Parish Office.

PRAYER OF THE WEEK

WALK LIGHTLY

Each leaf, each petal, each grain, each person, sings your praises, Creator God.
Each creature on the earth,
all the mountains and great seas,
show your glory, Spirit of love.
And yet the hand of greed has patented
and plundered your splendour,
has taken and not shared your gift,
has lived as owner of the earth, not guest.
And so, the ice is cracked, the rivers dry,
the valleys flooded and the snow caps melt.
God our Father, show us
how to step gently,
how to live simply,
how to walk lightly
with respect and love
for all that you have made. Amen.

THOUGHT FOR THE WEEK

"With each sunset, reflect; with each sunrise, renew."

PARISH COLLECTIONS

The **Offertory Collection for Sunday 6 September** came to **£1966.00. Dona £156.25.**

XX

The **Monthly Stipend** for the support of the priests came to **£1060.00. Dona £30.00.**

XX

If you wish to donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are:

Account Name: St Patricks Parish

Account Number: 70327727

Sort Code: 95-06-79 (please add an identifying name to your transaction) or you can contact the Parish Office for a Standing Order Form.

Thank you for your continued support and generosity.



PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA

Web Page: www.stteresasparrish.church

Email: stteresas@downandconnor.org

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 g.lyons@downandconnor.org

Parish Office Open Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am to 3pm.

13 September 2026, Twenty Fourth Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A .

Sunday Gospel *The story of the unforgiving servant is a lesson in what faithful forgiveness means. At the heart of forgiveness there is a grace. Grace is something that cannot be contained or controlled. Grace shows us that where there is real mercy and forgiveness, there is sharing and generosity. Put simply it means that if you fully receive the mercy of God, it will compel you to share it, to be kind and merciful to your neighbour. It is a difficult notion to understand in a world, or economy, where we are encouraged to be selfish and greedy and make sure that, 'nobody will make a fool out of me'. Time to get real about faith: if you seek and accept God's forgiveness its fruit is the forgiveness you will share with others. (Fr S Crumpton).*

Sunday Masses Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil **5pm**, St Matthias' **10am**, St Teresa's **12noon**.

Weekday Masses St Teresa's, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday & Friday **10am**.

St Matthias Monday **7pm**, Wednesday **9am**, Friday **7am** & Saturday **10am**.

Confessions Saturday **4 30pm** in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

Black Mountain Family of Parishes, **Season of Creation Celebration** in St Teresa's Church Thursday, 1 October 2026 at 7pm. All are welcome to attend.

To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.

Recently Deceased: Pauline McKenna, Bernie Robinson.

Months Mind: Ann Montgomery.

Anniversaries: Gerard McCann, Gerard Glennon, Harry Holland, Jack McIlroy, John McIlroy, Jimmy and Nan Moore.

Weekly Collection: £1 226. **Monthly Collection:** £1 989. *Thank you for your continued support.*

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. **Beginning Experience** is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26 September, 24 October and 21 November 2026) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com